- Integrating into continuous integration/continuous deployment (CI/CD) processes and pipelines

Often, repositories are split by application, service, or team, for example, frontend and backend. However, both teams need contracts, so the conversation starts to decide where the contracts should be stored. Contracts can be stored within the provider service repository or in an independent repository shared between teams. The contracts then need a custom implementation to share them between repositories within the testing phase. Pact Broker provides an easy way to share contracts. Another way that Pact Broker supports the contract testing process is by tracking contract changes between branches and environments. Throughout the development process, contracts will change, and different teams will make changes at different times.

Imagine the provider service has a bug in one of their endpoints. They fixed the bug in version 2.1.1 and want to deploy it as soon as possible. Therefore, the change to the API must be compatible with all consumer interactions. At the same time as the provider is making their change, consumers are also updating the UI with additional data from the API endpoint, changing their interactions in the contract. However, the consumers won't be deploying the changes until next week. In this situation, the provider service needs to verify the contract version in production and in the new contracts. As shown in figure 9.2, Pact Broker shows all the different contract versions and where the provider verifications point to, which makes the scenario described much easier to test.